

Text Formatting Elements

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What We'll Learn

By the end of this lesson, students can use basic HTML text formatting elements to emphasize and improve text content on a webpage.

Words We'll Use

- Formatting
- Bold
- Italic
- Emphasis
- Highlight

Before We Start

When you read a webpage, how do bold words, italic words, or highlighted words help you understand important information?

Let's Understand

HTML text formatting elements are used to change the appearance or meaning of text on a webpage.

Some formatting elements make text look different, such as bold, italic, small, marked, or underlined text.

Other formatting elements give meaning to the text, such as showing importance or emphasis.

Text formatting helps readers notice important words, understand key ideas, and read webpage content more clearly.

Let's Look at Examples

Bold and Strong Text



HTML Bold and Strong Text Example

Using `<b>` and `<strong>` to emphasize text

HTML Code

```
1 <!DOCTYPE html>
2 <html>
3   <head>
4     <title>Important Reminder</title>
5   </head>
6   <body>
7     <h1>Class Reminder</h1>
8     <p>Please bring your <b>notebook</b> tomorrow.</p>
9     <p><strong>Important:</strong> Submit your
10      activity before Friday.</p>
11   </body>
12 </html>
13
```

Browser Preview

Class Reminder

Please bring your **notebook** tomorrow.

Important: Submit your activity before Friday.



1. What this shows

`<b>` makes text **bold** for style.

`<strong>` shows important text.



2. Common mistake

```
<p><strong>Important:
Submit your activity.</p>
```

Don't forget the closing `</strong>` tag.



3. Mini-check

Which tag is better for important text: `<b>` or `<strong>`?

HTML bold and strong text example

Italic and Emphasized Text



HTML Highlighted Text Example



Using `<mark>` to highlight important text



HTML Code

```
1 <!DOCTYPE html>
2 <html lang="en">
3   <head>
4     <title>Mark Tag Example</title>
5   </head>
6   <body>
7     <h1>Project Update</h1>
8     <p>The deadline for the project is
9       <mark>Friday</mark>.
10  </body>
11 </html>
```



Browser Preview

file:///index.html

Project Update

The deadline for the project is **Friday**.

1

What this shows



The `<mark>` tag highlights text that is important or needs attention.

2

Common mistake

Incorrect example:

The deadline for the project is Friday.



Don't highlight almost the entire sentence. Only key words or phrases should be marked.

3

Mini-check



Which tag highlights important text?

{ }

.....

< / >

.....



.....

< / >

.....

Happy Coding! 😊

Italic and Emphasized Text

Highlighted and Small Text



HTML Emphasized Text Example



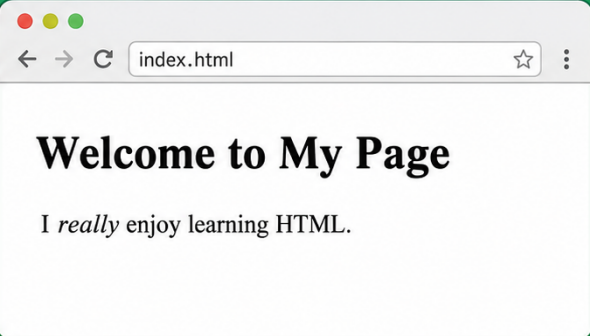
Using `<em>` to emphasize important words



HTML Code

```
1 <!DOCTYPE html>
2 <html lang="en">
3 <head>
4   <meta charset="UTF-8">
5   <title>Emphasis Example</title>
6 </head>
7 <body>
8   <h1>Welcome to My Page</h1>
9   <p>I <em>really</em> enjoy learning HTML.</p>
10 </body>
</html>
```

Browser Preview



1 What this shows



The `<em>` tag is used to **emphasize** a word or phrase. Emphasized text usually appears *italic* in browsers.

2 Common mistake



Leaving the tag open:

```
<p>I <em>really enjoy learning HTML.</p>
```



Using it on an entire long sentence:

```
<p><em>I really enjoy learning HTML and I use it every day because it is fun.</em></p>
```



Use emphasis only where needed to highlight important words or phrases.

3 Mini-check



Which tag is used to emphasize a word or phrase?



Remember: `<em>` adds meaning (emphasis). It helps both readers and search engines understand your content better!



Highlighted and Small Text

Example 4



HTML Small Text Example



Using `<small>` for secondary or fine-print text

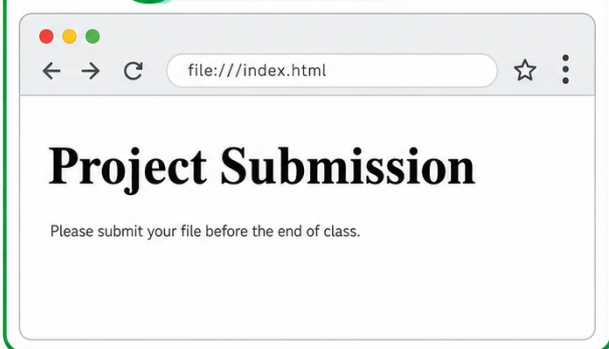


HTML Code

```
1 <!DOCTYPE html>
2 <html lang="en">
3   <head>
4     <meta charset="UTF-8">
5     <title>Small Text Example</title>
6   </head>
7   <body>
8     <h1>Project Submission</h1>
9     <p><small>Please submit your file
10       before the end of class.</small></p>
11   </body>
12 </html>
```



Browser Preview



1. What this shows

The `<small>` tag is used to display text that is less prominent. It's perfect for side notes, secondary text, or fine print.



2. Common mistake

Using `<small>` for too much of your main content.

```
<h1><small>Project Submission</small></h1>
<p><small>This is the main information
and it's all small.</small></p>
```



Use `<small>` only for less important text.



3. Mini-check

Which tag is used for smaller secondary text?

?



Tip: `<small>` doesn't change importance for search engines or screen readers. It's for **visual** presentation only.



Example 4

Let's Practice

Create a simple HTML page about your favorite subject.

Your page should include:

- One main heading
- One paragraph
- At least three formatted words or phrases

Use formatting elements such as:

- `<b>`
- `<strong>`
- `<i>`
- `<em>`
- `<mark>`
- `<small>`

Now We Apply

Create a short webpage about a school announcement.

Your webpage should include:

- A heading for the announcement title
- A paragraph explaining the announcement
- Important words formatted properly
- At least one highlighted word or phrase

Challenge Task

Improve your webpage by using at least five different text formatting elements.

Make sure the formatting is meaningful and not used randomly.

How Our Work Will Be Checked

- Correct use of text formatting elements
- Proper opening and closing tags
- Important words are emphasized clearly
- Content is easy to read
- Webpage displays correctly in the browser

Let's Reflect

Which text formatting element is most useful for showing important information? Why?

Resources / References

- [HTML text formatting guide](#)
- [images/html-text-formatting-elements.svg](#)
- [images/html-bold-strong-text.svg](#)
- [images/html-italic-emphasis-text.svg](#)
- [images/html-highlight-small-text.svg](#)